

AFRICAN HUMANITARIAN AGENCY

Foundational Operational Framework 2

Humanitarian Financing and Resource Mobilisation Framework

1. Purpose

This framework sets out how the African Humanitarian Agency (AfHA) will mobilise, govern, allocate, manage and account for financial and in-kind resources in support of its humanitarian mandate. It provides the strategic and operational basis for building a financing system that is predictable, African led, transparent and responsive to the realities of humanitarian risk across the continent.

The framework is intended to ensure that AfHA can move beyond fragmented and reactive funding towards a coherent financing architecture that supports preparedness, anticipatory action, rapid response, surge support, coordination, information management and institutional sustainability. It also defines how AfHA will engage Member States, the African Union (AU), Regional Economic Communities (RECs), bilateral and multilateral partners, philanthropic actors, the private sector and other stakeholders in a structured resource mobilisation effort. It finances these functions and defines their resource requirements, while the detailed operating models for coordination, information management, surge readiness, preparedness, anticipatory action and advocacy are governed by the companion foundational frameworks.

2. Rationale

Humanitarian financing in Africa remains heavily shaped by short-term appeals, external earmarking and uneven donor attention. This often results in delayed action, insufficient investment in preparedness, weak support for continental and regional systems, and overdependence on international actors for both operational resources and strategic direction. At the same time, the frequency and complexity of crises in Africa require a financing model that can support early action, cross-border solidarity, and coordinated regional and continental responses.

AfHA is being established to strengthen African leadership in humanitarian action. That ambition cannot be realised without a financing architecture that reflects African ownership while remaining open to complementary support from external partners. The Agency therefore requires a framework that distinguishes among core institutional financing, operational financing, contingency financing, anticipatory financing, surge financing, and in-kind support, and clearly links these to governance, accountability, and decision-making.

This framework responds to that need. It positions financing not as a stand-alone administrative issue, but as a central enabler of AfHA's legitimacy, readiness and effectiveness. In designing this financing architecture, AfHA draws deliberately on the accumulated practice of comparable regional humanitarian and civil protection financing models. That experience points consistently to a small number of design choices that distinguish financially sustainable institutions from those that remain perpetually dependent on external goodwill. These include assessed rather than voluntary member contributions as the primary structural backbone; a multi-year commitment framework that allows planning and investment horizons to extend beyond a single year; pre-qualified partner financing arrangements that reduce bureaucratic friction at the point of need; a dedicated solidarity reserve or emergency contingency fund that is capitalised in advance rather than mobilised reactively; and the systematic separation of core institutional financing from operational and emergency financing windows so that crisis drawdowns do not hollow out institutional capacity. The framework for anticipatory action financing draws additionally on the anatomy of forecast-based financing mechanisms that have demonstrated their effectiveness in linking trigger conditions, pre-authorised actions and pre-positioned resources across multiple hazard contexts. All of these practices are incorporated in this framework, adapted to AfHA's Statute, to African institutional realities and to the AU's financial rules and procedures.

3. Objectives

This framework pursues the following objectives:

- Define the overall financing architecture for AfHA.
- Clarify the roles of African and non-African funding streams in supporting AfHA.

- Establish the principles for pooled, predictable and accountable financing.
- Define financing windows for start-up, preparedness, anticipatory action, surge, coordination and emergency response.
- Set out resource mobilisation approaches for different categories of partners.
- Establish governance and oversight principles for financial management and allocation.
- Support alignment between financing decisions and AfHA's operational frameworks and standard operating procedures.
- Strengthen trust through clear accountability, reporting and review mechanisms.
- Promote a gradual shift towards increased African financing of humanitarian coordination and action.

4. Scope

This framework applies to all financial and resource mobilisation functions of AfHA across all phases of the crisis cycle and all levels of the AfHA system. It covers the following resource categories:

- core institutional financing
- programme and operational financing
- pooled and earmarked humanitarian financing
- emergency contingency resources
- anticipatory action financing
- surge and standby financing
- in-kind support and non-financial contributions
- partner contributions to systems, training, logistics and infrastructure
- financing linked to Regional Centres and logistics depots
- private sector, philanthropic and innovative financing mechanisms.

It applies to AfHA Headquarters, Regional Centres and any financing instrument or mechanism managed by, channelled through, or formally linked to AfHA.

5. Normative basis

This framework is grounded in the following instruments, policies and frameworks:

- the Statute of the African Humanitarian Agency
- relevant AU decisions on humanitarian action, solidarity and financing
- AU financial and administrative rules and procedures
- the Continental Humanitarian Coordination and Partnership Framework
- the Humanitarian Data and Information Interoperability Framework
- the Capacity Development and Surge Readiness Framework
- the Preparedness, Anticipatory Action, and Risk Reduction Framework
- any approved AU or AfHA policy instruments related to pooled funds, emergency allocations and accountability.

Framework 2 is the financial enabling framework for AfHA's wider operational architecture. It defines how resources are mobilised, governed, allocated, released, tracked and reported. It does not replace the companion frameworks that define AfHA's coordination structures, information products, surge systems, preparedness architecture, anticipatory action procedures or advocacy pathways. Where this framework refers to those functions, it does so only to define the financing, resource mobilisation and accountability arrangements required to support them.

6. Guiding principles

Nine guiding principles govern AfHA's financing model. They apply to all financing streams, all contribution modalities and all allocation decisions, and they inform the interpretation of every subsequent section of this framework.

6.1 African ownership

AfHA's financing model must reinforce African leadership and gradually increase the share of African-sourced resources in humanitarian coordination, preparedness and response. This principle is not merely aspirational: it requires deliberate design choices, including assessed contributions, domestic financing innovation and the explicit protection of African-controlled financing windows from external conditionality.

6.2 Predictability

AfHA should seek multi-year, stable and programmatic financing wherever possible in order to plan, staff and invest in systems with confidence. Predictable financing is the single most important enabler of institutional sustainability. A multi-year commitment framework, analogous to the long-term budget arrangements that give comparable civil protection and humanitarian financing mechanisms their planning stability, should be AfHA's primary financing ambition.

6.3 Flexibility

A portion of available financing should remain sufficiently flexible to support rapid adaptation, emergency allocation and anticipatory action. Flexibility and accountability are not in tension: pre-agreed flexible windows, with defined ceilings and approval pathways, enable speed while preserving control.

6.4 Additionality

AfHA financing should add value to existing national, regional and continental resources rather than merely relabelling or duplicating them. Each financing stream must demonstrate a clear additionality case.

6.5 Complementarity

The financing model must complement national systems, REC arrangements and existing continental instruments. AfHA should not displace functioning financing mechanisms but should fill gaps, pool resources and strengthen coordination of existing flows.

6.6 Transparency

All contributions, allocations and expenditures must be recorded, traceable and reportable through agreed systems. Transparency is both an accountability obligation and a resource mobilisation asset: partners who can see how their resources are used are more likely to maintain and deepen their support.

6.7 Accountability

Financial decisions must be subject to clear approval pathways, review, audit and performance monitoring. AfHA's accountability standards should be commensurate with those required by its most demanding partners, applied consistently regardless of funding source.

6.8 Equity and solidarity

Financing should support balanced and needs-based action across regions, including contexts that are historically underfunded or overlooked. Continental solidarity implies that better-resourced regions contribute to the capacity of less-resourced ones.

6.9 Speed with control

Emergency and anticipatory financing mechanisms must enable rapid release of resources while preserving minimum fiduciary safeguards. The design goal is documented speed, not undocumented speed. Pre-agreed procedures, pre-authorised ceilings and exception registers allow fast action without bypassing accountability.

7. Strategic financing architecture

AfHA's financing architecture comprises seven interlinked resource streams. Each stream has a defined purpose, a target capitalisation approach and a distinct governance pathway. The architecture is designed so that streams are clearly bounded: a drawdown on the emergency contingency stream does not compromise the core institutional stream, and flexibility in the anticipatory action stream does not erode the predictability of operational support financing. The table below summarises the streams; the sections that follow describe each in detail.

Table 1: AfHA financing architecture resource streams

Stream	Purpose	Primary source	Governance pathway
7.1 Core institutional	Institutional survival and basic functioning	African assessed contributions and AU sources	Board approval; annual budget
7.2 Operational support	Coordination, information, regional systems, training	Pooled and programmatic partner contributions	Programme approval cycle
7.3 Emergency contingency	Rapid release in the first hours and days of a crisis	Dedicated capitalised reserve	Pre-approved ceiling; Secretariat authority
7.4 Anticipatory action	Action before forecast impact	Pre-positioned and forecast-linked finance	Trigger-based automatic or near-automatic release
7.5 Surge and standby	Human surge capacity maintenance and deployment	Partner and pooled contributions	Operational request and cost-sharing framework
7.6 In-kind and enabling	Non-cash support; secondments; equipment; systems	Member States, RECs and partners	Registration, valuation and allocation records
7.7 Solidarity reserve	Capitalised continental emergency backstop	African sources; AU solidarity contributions	Governing Board; defined drawdown criteria

7.1 Core institutional financing

This stream supports the basic functioning of AfHA as an institution. It is the backbone of AfHA's sustainability, and it should be the first stream to be structurally secured through AUC-sourced revenue. Comparable mechanisms demonstrate that institutions whose core costs depend on voluntary partner contributions lose their independence and their planning horizon simultaneously. The design imperative is that core financing must not be jeopardised by operational fluctuations or crisis drawdowns.

Core institutional financing covers the following:

- headquarters operations
- staff salaries and benefits
- governance and Board support
- corporate services
- finance, legal and compliance functions
- strategic communications
- policy, monitoring and learning functions
- basic regional presence costs.

Core financing should increasingly be met by African sources over time, including AU assessed contributions, host country support, contributions from Member States and any approved continental financing arrangements.

7.2 Operational support financing

This stream supports AfHA's functional work across its six coordination and operational roles. It is distinct from core institutional financing and may be partly supported through pooled, programmatic and partner-specific contributions, including multi-year grants. AfHA should actively seek to design this stream around multi-year programmatic contributions rather than fragmented annual project grants, so that operational planning and staffing can extend beyond a single budget cycle.

This stream finances activities whose operational design is governed by the relevant companion frameworks: coordination support by Framework 1, information management by Framework 3, training and surge readiness by Framework 4, and preparedness and anticipatory action by Framework 5.

Operational support financing covers the following:

- coordination support
- information management
- regional engagement
- capacity building
- training and exercises
- surge standby systems
- logistics preparedness
- support to contingency planning
- technical missions and deployments.

7.3 Emergency contingency financing

This stream supports the rapid release of resources in the early hours or days of a declared crisis. It is designed for speed, and its governance procedures are pre-agreed precisely so that deliberation does not introduce delay when lives are at stake. The stream should be capitalised in advance, maintained at a defined minimum level and replenished after drawdown through a defined cycle. Comparable emergency reserve mechanisms demonstrate that capitalisation in routine periods, rather than mobilisation after activation, is the only model that consistently delivers within operationally meaningful timeframes.

The stream should allow AfHA to do the following:

- activate coordination systems
- deploy surge support
- fund initial technical missions
- support urgent logistics and operational requirements
- co-finance immediate response measures within approved parameters.

This stream should be capitalised through a designated contingency window with clear triggers and approval thresholds. Emergency financing decisions should be supported by the activation pathways in Framework 1, the incident briefs and situation products in Framework 3, and the surge deployment procedures in Framework 4. Framework 2 governs the release thresholds, approval authority, eligible costs and financial control measures.

7.4 Anticipatory action financing

This stream is one of the most important and one of the most technically distinct elements of AfHA's financing architecture. It supports action before a forecast hazard or risk fully materialises, enabling the shift from reactive emergency response to proactive risk-informed action that demonstrably reduces humanitarian impact and overall response cost. The fundamental design principle of anticipatory action financing is the advance determination of what will happen when a specified trigger is reached: which resources will be released, to whom, for what actions, over what timeline and subject to what post-action review. This determination cannot be made at the moment of crisis; it must be made in advance.

Anticipatory action financing depends on five elements that are defined operationally in the Preparedness, Anticipatory Action and Risk Reduction Framework: credible trigger conditions, pre-authorised action sets, pre-positioned or fast-release resources, designated approval authority and post-action review.

This stream should be linked to pre-agreed triggers, hazard-specific playbooks, pre-authorised actions, cross-border preparedness where relevant and collaboration with risk financing and early warning systems. AfHA should build this stream progressively: beginning with two or three well-specified anticipatory action scenarios in hazard types and geographies where data quality and lead times are sufficient, then expanding the portfolio as experience accumulates.

Where Member States have established their own parametric or forecast-linked disaster financing instruments, AfHA's anticipatory action stream should be designed to complement rather than duplicate them. AfHA's distinctive contribution at the continental level is the ability to activate cross-border or multi-country anticipatory action where individual Member State mechanisms cannot reach, and to mobilise continental political support for rapid pre-crisis action where national systems are hesitant or overwhelmed.

7.5 Surge and standby financing

This stream finances the surge and standby system governed by the Capacity Development and Surge Readiness Framework. This Framework defines the cost categories, funding sources, approval pathways, cost-sharing arrangements and financial controls for surge readiness and deployment. Framework 4 governs roster design, competency standards, certification, deployment readiness, duty of care, simulation, performance review and learning.

This stream covers the following cost categories:

- roster management
- training and simulation
- deployment travel and subsistence
- insurance and duty of care
- technical standby contracts
- standby communications
- equipment.

7.6 In-kind and enabling resource support

Not all support needs to be cash-based. In-kind contributions represent a significant proportion of the support that Member States, RECs and partners can realistically provide, and a structured approach to their management prevents hidden dependency and governance complications. All in-kind contributions should be registered, valued where feasible and included in AfHA's financial reporting so that the full resource picture is visible.

In-kind and enabling support includes the following:

- seconded personnel
- office space and utilities
- vehicles
- software and digital systems
- logistics support
- warehousing and depot access
- communications infrastructure
- technical advisory services.

7.7 Solidarity reserve

AfHA should establish and maintain a capitalised continental solidarity reserve as a backstop financing instrument distinct from the operational emergency contingency stream. The solidarity reserve is designed for situations where the scale or duration of a crisis, or an accumulation of

concurrent crises, exceeds the capacity of the emergency contingency stream and where no Member State or partner bridge financing is immediately available. It is the institutional expression of continental humanitarian solidarity in financial form.

The solidarity reserve should have the following design features:

- a defined minimum capitalisation target, established by the Governing Board and expressed as a proportion of AfHA's estimated maximum emergency response liability in a major multi-country crisis scenario
- funding from African sources as a priority, including assessed solidarity contributions from Member States, budget transfers from the African Union and contributions from host countries, supplemented by partner start-up contributions in the early phases
- a defined drawdown criteria specifying the scale or type of event that qualifies for reserve activation, distinct from the thresholds governing the emergency contingency stream
- a replenishment obligation requiring that drawdowns be notified to the Governing Board and replenished within a defined cycle
- ring-fencing from operational budgets so that the reserve cannot be depleted by routine shortfalls or programme overruns
- independent audit of reserve balances and drawdown justifications as part of AfHA's standard annual audit cycle.

8. Financing windows

To operationalise the architecture in section 7, AfHA organises resources through five clear financing windows (in line with the financial calendar of the AUC). Each window has a defined purpose, defined eligibility criteria and a defined approval pathway. Keeping the number of windows limited and clearly bounded reduces administrative complexity for both AfHA and its contributors, and makes it easier for partners to understand where their contributions will flow and what they will support.

These windows finance functions that are implemented through the companion frameworks. Their purpose is to define eligibility, release and accountability arrangements rather than to restate the operational design of coordination, information, surge, preparedness or advocacy systems.

8.1 Window 1: Secretariat and governance window

This window supports the following:

- headquarters administration
- governance structures
- legal and fiduciary systems
- core staffing
- compliance and oversight.

8.2 Window 2: Regionalisation and systems window

This window supports the following:

- Regional Centre set up/support and running costs
- information systems
- situation rooms
- data and interoperability systems
- prepositioning of supplies/aid
- logistics mapping and depot support
- training and systems development.

8.3 Window 3: Preparedness and anticipatory action window

This window supports the following:

- risk analysis
- contingency planning
- pre-positioning
- simulation and readiness
- early warning and triggers
- hazard specific anticipatory actions
- cross border preparedness.

8.4 Window 4: Emergency activation and surge window

This window supports the following:

- emergency activation costs
- surge deployment
- immediate coordination support
- early technical missions
- emergency communications and transport
- rapid procurement under emergency procedures

8.5 Window 5: Partnership, learning and innovation window

This window supports the following:

- knowledge exchange
- peer learning
- policy and financing studies
- innovation pilots
- lessons learned reviews
- partner engagement platforms
- AfHA may refine these windows over time, but they should remain simple, understandable and linked to clear approval pathways.

9. Sources of finance

AfHA's financing will be drawn from seven categories of sources. The framework deliberately sequences these sources in terms of their strategic priority: African sources should be the structural backbone, with external contributions in a supplementary and catalytic role. This sequencing is not prescriptive about the proportion that each source will contribute in early phases when African sources may still be building, but it is explicit about the long-term direction of travel.

9.1 African Union sources

AU-linked sources represent the foundation of AfHA's long-term institutional sustainability and are the primary expression of the African ownership principle. AfHA should actively work with the AU Commission and Member States to develop a formal assessed-contribution model, analogous to the biennial member-state contribution arrangements that underpin comparable regional mechanisms, in which each AU Member State contributes a defined and predictable amount based on an agreed formula rather than on voluntary goodwill.

Potential AU-linked sources include the following:

- assessed contributions and budget allocations
- humanitarian financing reforms agreed by AU organs
- linked continental funding mechanisms
- approved solidarity financing instruments
- host country support arrangements
- (private sector and philanthropic contributions?)
- African Risk Capacity.

These sources should be the backbone of long-term institutional sustainability.

9.2 Member State contributions

Member State contributions beyond the AU assessment framework form a second tier of African-sourced support. The framework strongly encourages the development of a voluntary-plus-assessed contribution structure in which all Member States contribute at least a minimum assessed level and those with greater capacity contribute additionally either in cash or in-kind. Member States should be supported to understand their contribution as an investment in continental solidarity that benefits their own populations in future crises.

Member States may contribute through the following modalities:

- direct cash contributions
- assessed or voluntary contributions
- earmarked contributions to specific windows
- support to Regional Centres hosted in their territories
- secondments and in-kind assets
- standby capacities and technical expertise.

Member States should be encouraged to support both the principle and the practice of African humanitarian solidarity.

9.3 Bilateral and multilateral partners

Bilateral and multilateral partners play an important and legitimate role in AfHA's financing, particularly in the start-up and scale-up phases before African assessed contributions reach their target levels. However, the framework is explicit that partner contributions should be structured to complement African leadership rather than to displace it, and that partners should be actively steered toward multi-year, pooled and programmatic contributions that support AfHA's strategic priorities rather than partner-defined project agendas.

Eligible bilateral and multilateral partners include the following:

- humanitarian donors
- development agencies
- multilateral development banks
- pooled funds
- regional cooperation programmes
- Africa-Arab Response Fund.

Their support may be provided through the following modalities:

- start-up funding
- programme financing
- capitalisation of pooled windows
- co-financing of systems and operations
- technical support grants.

AfHA should encourage these partners to favour multi-year and pooled approaches over fragmented short-term projects.

9.4 Philanthropic and foundation support

Philanthropic and foundation partners offer a degree of flexibility and risk tolerance that government donors typically cannot, making them particularly suitable for innovation, anticipatory action piloting, systems development and catalytic investments that lack an established evidence base. AfHA

should develop a clear philanthropic engagement strategy that defines which activities qualify for foundation support, how proposals are developed, and how reporting obligations are managed in a proportionate manner.

Foundation support may include the following areas:

- innovation
- anticipatory action
- systems development
- training and knowledge
- catalytic start-up investment
- research and evaluation.

9.5 Private sector support

Private-sector actors can contribute significant financial and non-financial value to AfHA, particularly in logistics, communications, technology, risk financing, and innovation. Engagement must be subject to rigorous due diligence, including conflict-of-interest assessment, humanitarian principles review and reputational risk screening. AfHA should develop a private-sector engagement policy, consistent with AU rules, that defines eligible and ineligible partners and the terms on which private-sector contributions will be accepted.

Private sector support may include the following:

- direct financing
- in-kind support
- logistics and communications services
- technology partnerships
- innovation funds
- insurance and risk solutions
- pro bono expertise.

Private sector engagement must be subject to due diligence, conflict of interest management and humanitarian principles.

9.6 Innovative financing

Innovative financing instruments represent a growing and increasingly important component of humanitarian and disaster risk financing globally. AfHA should invest in understanding, piloting and gradually deploying those instruments that are most appropriate to its mandate, its capacity and the risk landscape it serves. The following instruments have demonstrated particular relevance in comparable contexts and should be explored as AfHA's systems and governance mature.

- Parametric insurance and catastrophe risk transfer instruments use pre-agreed indices, such as wind speed, rainfall deficit, agricultural strain, or seismic intensity, to trigger automatic payouts to governments or to humanitarian response funds when a threshold is crossed. Payout is rapid because there is no need for damage assessment: the index determines the payment. Several African governments have already engaged with parametric insurance through continental risk financing mechanisms. AfHA can add value by helping to link national parametric instruments to continental response financing, by advocating for terms that serve humanitarian rather than only fiscal purposes, and by exploring whether a continental AfHA-level parametric instrument is feasible over time.
- Forecast-linked financing instruments connect the release of resources to a forecast probability of impact. This is the financing logic that supports anticipatory action: resources are released not when a disaster has struck but when a hazard is likely to strike (possibly leading to disaster) within the available lead time. The operational trigger design, blueprint approval and activation procedures are governed by Framework 5, while this framework governs the financing window, release authority and financial controls required to act on those triggers.

- Endowment and quasi-endowment arrangements allow a portion of AfHA's reserves to be invested prudently so that annual returns contribute to the operating budget or the solidarity reserve, reducing the pressure on annual member contributions over time. This model requires sufficient initial capitalisation and sound investment governance, but it has been used successfully by comparable humanitarian financing institutions to build long-term sustainability.
- Solidarity levies on commercial transactions, telecommunications, financial transfers or air travel have been explored in several African contexts as a mechanism for generating domestic humanitarian financing without relying on government budget appropriations. The political and legislative pathways are complex, but AfHA can support Member States in exploring these options and can advocate for the application of any proceeds to continental humanitarian solidarity mechanisms.
- Blended finance arrangements combine concessional public or philanthropic capital with private finance to reach investment volumes that neither source could achieve independently. In the humanitarian financing context, blended finance is most relevant for preparedness systems and risk-reduction infrastructure where there is a long-term return or risk reduction value that can attract private capital alongside grant funding.

These should be piloted cautiously and only where governance and transparency can be assured.

9.7 Multi-year commitment and partner framework arrangements

One of the most important lessons from comparable financing mechanisms is that the structure through which contributions are committed matters as much as their volume. AfHA should develop two complementary framework instruments to secure more predictable and less administratively burdensome contributions from its partners.

The first is a multi-year commitment framework, in which major contributors, whether Member States, bilateral partners or multilateral institutions, commit indicative multi-year financing envelopes covering two to four years rather than single annual contributions. A multi-year framework does not legally bind contributors beyond their annual appropriation cycles, but it creates a shared planning basis, signals intent, enables AfHA to staff and invest ahead of confirmed receipts, and reduces the annual negotiation burden on both sides. The framework should specify annual tranches, the conditions under which AfHA will report on use of the previous tranche and the circumstances in which the commitment may be reviewed.

The second is a set of partner framework agreements, analogous to the pre-qualification arrangements used by major humanitarian financing bodies to reduce procurement and contracting friction at the point of activation. AfHA should develop standard framework financing agreements for its principal partner categories, pre-agreed and signed in routine periods, so that specific contributions can be activated rapidly when needed rather than triggering a full procurement or legal review process under crisis conditions. Framework agreements should include pre-agreed reporting formats, audit rights, reallocation procedures and humanitarian principles provisions.

10. Resource mobilisation strategy

AfHA should adopt a structured and sustained resource mobilisation strategy built around six approaches. The strategy is not a one-time launch effort but a standing institutional function, led by the Secretariat with dedicated resource mobilisation capacity. Early wins in mobilisation build institutional confidence and partner trust; systematic reporting on resource use sustains and deepens that trust over time.

Resource mobilisation is both a financial and political function. This Framework defines the financing instruments, contribution modalities and partner engagement pathways through which resources are secured. The political advocacy, visibility, messaging, high level engagement and reputational risk management required to support resource mobilisation are governed by the Political Advocacy and Visibility Framework.

10.1 Political resource mobilisation

Use AU political processes, ambassadorial engagement, high-level forums and AU Summit moments to secure commitments from Member States and strategic partners. This Framework defines the financing instruments into which commitments are channelled, while Framework 6 governs the advocacy narrative, visibility strategy, messaging discipline and high-level engagement approach that support those commitments.

10.2 Programmatic resource mobilisation

Present AfHA's financing needs through coherent, phased programme windows linked to the implementation roadmap, rather than through isolated project proposals. Programmatic mobilisation allows partners to see how their contributions fit into a larger design, increases the likelihood of multi-year commitment and reduces the administrative burden of managing multiple small grants. AfHA should develop a consolidated programme document that describes all five financing windows and their phased capitalisation targets, so that any partner can identify where and how it can contribute most effectively.

10.3 Strategic partnership resource mobilisation

Cultivate long-term financing partnerships with institutions able to support multiple pillars of AfHA's work over time. Strategic partners are those that contribute to more than one financing window, that are willing to commit multi-year envelopes and that are aligned with AfHA's principles of African ownership and additionality. AfHA should identify a small number of priority strategic financing partners within its first year of operation and invest in those relationships through regular dialogue, joint review and co-design of programmatic contributions.

10.4 Crisis-linked mobilisation

When major crises occur, use AfHA's position and its demonstrated coordination value to support rapid mobilisation into established windows rather than creating ad hoc financing structures for each event. Crisis-linked mobilisation is most effective when AfHA has already demonstrated competence: partners who have seen AfHA coordinate effectively in a crisis are significantly more willing to channel resources through AfHA in the next one. AfHA should therefore treat each major activation as both a coordination event and a resource mobilisation opportunity, documenting and communicating what AfHA's coordination contribution achieved and what additional resources could have enabled.

10.5 Learning-based mobilisation

Use evidence, annual reporting, early wins, case studies and independent evaluations to build partner confidence and attract further support. The most powerful mobilisation instrument available to AfHA is a credible, transparent and independently verified account of what its resources achieved. AfHA should invest in a results measurement and learning function from inception and ensure that its annual financing report connects resource inputs to humanitarian outcomes in language that financing partners and AU Member States find compelling and credible.

10.6 Domestic resource mobilisation

AfHA should actively support the development of domestic humanitarian financing capacity within Member States as a complementary dimension of its continental resource mobilisation strategy. Domestic resource mobilisation from within Africa, whether through government budget allocations, national disaster risk financing instruments, telecommunications or financial sector levies, or national philanthropic mobilisation, is the most politically sustainable foundation for AfHA's long-term financing. AfHA can add value by advocating for domestic financing policy reform, sharing knowledge of successful domestic instruments from within and outside the continent, supporting Member States in designing national disaster risk financing frameworks that link to continental windows, and facilitating peer learning between Member States on financing innovation.

11. Financial governance and oversight

AfHA's financial governance model must be robust enough to meet the accountability expectations of its most demanding partners while remaining workable within the AU institutional framework. The governance structure has four levels: the Governing Board, the Executive Secretary, the Finance and Administration function and the internal control and audit function. Each level has defined responsibilities and authorities, and the relationships between them are governed by AfHA's financial policies and the AU financial rules and procedures.

11.1 Governing Board

The Governing Board will provide strategic oversight of the financing architecture, including:

- review of annual budgets and financing plans
- review of financing window design
- oversight of major resource mobilisation strategies
- review of annual financial and performance reports
- retrospective oversight of significant emergency allocations as required.

11.2 Executive Secretary

The Secretariat will be responsible for:

- overall implementation of this framework
- budgeting
- authorising resource mobilisation actions within delegated authority
- overseeing budget execution
- ensuring compliance with AU rules and AfHA policies
- approving emergency and anticipatory allocations within thresholds
- reporting to the Board and AU structures.

11.3 Finance and administration function

AfHA's finance function will:

- manage financial systems and controls
- maintain contribution records
- track allocations and expenditure
- prepare financial reports
- support audits and reviews
- manage donor reporting where applicable
- advise on financial risk and compliance.

11.4 Internal control and audit

The framework requires:

- segregation of duties
- defined approval thresholds
- exception registers for emergency actions
- internal compliance review
- independent external audit as required
- regular financial reporting.

12. Budgeting model (will this work into AUC processes?)

AfHA should use a phased budgeting model that aligns with the operational roadmap and AUC requirements.

AfHA should adopt a biennial budget framework aligned with a two-year work plan cycle, which provides a more realistic planning horizon than annual budgeting while remaining within the management capacity of a new institution. Each biennium should have a defined budget envelope agreed by the Governing Board, a first-year operational allocation and a second-year indicative plan that is confirmed once first-year performance and resource availability are assessed. This model mirrors the biennial planning cycles used effectively by comparable regional mechanisms and is consistent with the multi-year commitment framework described in section 9.7.

12.1 Phase 1

This phase prioritises the following:

- headquarters set up
- start-up staffing
- governance and legal systems
- core frameworks and SOPs
- initial situation room and data systems
- early surge readiness
- initial partner engagement.

12.2 Phase 2

This phase prioritises the following:

- Regional Centres
- logistics depots and regional systems
- expanded surge roster
- anticipatory action pilots
- integrated information systems
- joint operations support
- stronger partner engagement.

12.3 Phase 3

This phase prioritises the following:

- steady state institutional sustainability
- maintenance and upgrade of systems
- mature surge and preparedness mechanisms
- expanded financing diversification
- regular evaluation and learning
- stronger African share of core financing.

13. Allocation principles

Resource allocation under this framework should be guided by clear and consistently applied principles that are known to partners and Member States in advance. Predictable allocation principles reduce politicisation, build partner confidence and allow AfHA to defend its decisions with reference to transparent criteria. The following principles govern allocation decisions across all windows:

- humanitarian need and risk
- strategic value of preparedness and early action
- regional balance and equity
- feasibility and absorptive capacity
- alignment with AfHA mandate
- complementarity with national and regional systems
- ability to demonstrate catalytic value.

Not all allocations should be reactive. A significant proportion should support readiness and system building. Allocation decisions should be documented, including the rationale for departures from standard principles in exceptional circumstances. The Secretariat should maintain an allocation register accessible to the Governing Board and, in appropriate summary form, to partners and Member States.

14. Emergency financing procedures

This framework should be read alongside the SOP for emergency activation and authorisation, the SOP for delegation of authority and rapid decision-making, the coordination activation arrangements in Framework 1, the evidence products in Framework 3 and the surge deployment procedures in Framework 4.

Emergency financing arrangements should include the following elements:

- Pre-approved emergency ceilings
- dedicated emergency budget lines
- simplified request and approval forms
- pre-qualified suppliers and framework agreements
- rapid disbursement procedures
- retrospective control and audit
- review after deactivation.

Emergency financing must be fast, but never undocumented. The key governance provision for emergency financing is a tiered authorisation model: small, fast-moving emergency allocations up to a defined ceiling may be authorised by the Secretariat with immediate notification to the Governing Board; larger allocations require retrospective Board ratification within a defined period; and allocations exceeding a higher ceiling require prospective Board approval, or in urgent cases the agreement of a defined minimum quorum of Board members by written procedure. The specific ceilings and procedures sit in the SOP for emergency fund activation and release.

15. Anticipatory action financing procedures

This section sets out the financing procedure for the activation of anticipatory action. It should be read alongside the Preparedness, Anticipatory Action and Risk Reduction Framework, which governs blueprint development, trigger design, pre-authorised actions, activation logic and post-action learning.

Step 1: Blueprint development (routine phase)

Before any activation is possible, the relevant hazard-specific anticipatory action blueprint must be approved under Framework 5 and linked to a confirmed source of financing. This Framework confirms the eligible expenditure categories, ceiling, approval pathway, disbursement mechanism and reporting requirements for the blueprint.

Step 2: Trigger monitoring (routine and heightened readiness phase)

Trigger monitoring and confirmation are governed by Frameworks 3 and 5. For financing purposes, AfHA records the trigger evidence, the confirming authority, the applicable financing ceiling and the delegated approval pathway before release is authorised.

Step 3: Trigger confirmation and activation decision

When the designated early warning authority confirms that the trigger threshold has been met or exceeded, the financing authority reviews the confirmation against the approved blueprint and authorises release within the delegated ceiling and lead-time requirement.

Step 4: Implementation and monitoring

Resources are released to pre-authorised implementing actors according to the approved blueprint and financing agreement. This Framework tracks disbursement, expenditure, exceptions and reporting, while operational implementation monitoring is governed by Framework 5 and supported by Framework 3 information products.

Step 5: Post-action review

Within a defined period after the anticipated impact has passed, the post-action review assesses both operational performance and financial performance. This Framework focuses on whether resources were released on time, used for authorised purposes, documented properly and reported in a way that strengthens future financing confidence.

16. In-kind support management

In-kind contributions require a structured management process to prevent hidden operational dependency, governance complications and reporting gaps. AfHA should establish and maintain a dedicated in-kind contribution register as part of its financial systems, ensuring that non-cash support is as visible and accountable as cash contributions.

The in-kind management process should include the following steps:

- registration of offers
- due diligence on providers
- valuation where feasible
- allocation and use records
- maintenance and ownership clarification
- reporting on utilisation.

In-kind contributions should not create hidden operational dependency or governance complications.

17. Reporting and accountability

AfHA should report on financing at three levels. Financial reporting should draw on the evidence base and traceable information products defined in the Humanitarian Data and Information Interoperability Framework, including activation records, situation reports, resource request evidence packages, expenditure-linked outputs and post-action review information.

17.1 Internal management reporting

Internal management reporting provides the Secretariat and senior team with the financial intelligence needed for timely decision-making. It should be produced on a monthly or quarterly rhythm and should cover the following:

- contributions received
- allocations made
- expenditure against budget
- risks and bottlenecks
- funding gaps.

17.2 Governance reporting

Governance reporting provides the Governing Board and AU structures with the oversight information they need to fulfil their fiduciary and strategic responsibilities. It should be produced on a semi-annual or annual rhythm and should cover the following:

- annual budget execution
- resource mobilisation performance

- emergency and anticipatory allocations
- financing gaps and sustainability trends
- audit findings and corrective action.

17.3 External reporting

External reporting provides partners and stakeholders with the transparency they need to maintain and deepen their support. It should be published on AfHA's platforms and shared directly with contributors, and it should be designed to be accessible to non-specialist audiences, including AU Member State government officials, civil society partners and the public.

External reports should cover the following:

- use of contributions
- value for money
- outputs and outcomes
- financial integrity and compliance
- lessons and adjustments.

Reporting should be proportionate and harmonised where possible to reduce burden.

18. Risk management

The following table summarises the principal financing risks under this framework and the primary mitigation measures AfHA will apply. The risk register should be reviewed by the Governing Board at least annually and updated to reflect emerging financing conditions.

Table 2: Risks and mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Overdependence on external financing	Progressively increase African-sourced resources; protect core functions through assessed contributions; apply the multi-year commitment framework to reduce volatility
Excessive earmarking	Promote pooled and programmatic financing windows; include de-earmarking provisions in partner framework agreements; limit single-purpose contributions as a proportion of any window
Slow emergency disbursement	Pre-approve thresholds, templates, emergency budget lines and supplier framework agreements; implement tiered authorisation model with pre-delegated authority for fast-moving events
Weak fiduciary systems	Strengthen finance systems and segregation of duties from inception; conduct annual independent audit; develop finance function ahead of resource growth rather than reactively
Partner-driven distortion of priorities	Anchor all financing in AfHA-approved strategy and windows; review partner proposals against the complementarity test; maintain an African priorities filter in all resource mobilisation processes
Reputational damage from poor reporting	Maintain timely, accurate and transparent reporting; invest in results measurement; ensure that financial reports connect inputs to humanitarian outcomes

Risk	Mitigation
Unsustainable expansion	Link budget growth to realistic absorptive capacity; apply the phased budget logic; commission absorptive capacity assessments before major scale-up decisions
Trigger manipulation or politicisation of anticipatory financing	Pre-agree triggers with early warning institutions on technical rather than political grounds; require independent trigger confirmation; maintain post-action review as a systematic discipline

19. Performance indicators

The following indicators provide a minimum framework for assessing the performance of this financing model. They should be reviewed and refined annually through the governance reporting cycle, and additional context-specific indicators may be added as AfHA's systems mature.

Indicative indicators for this framework may include:

- proportion of core budget financed from African sources
- value of pooled versus fragmented contributions
- time from activation to emergency fund release
- value allocated to anticipatory action
- number of partners contributing through multi-year arrangements
- proportion of contributions reported on time
- value of in-kind support mobilised
- proportion of budget spent on preparedness versus only response
- audit findings and closure rates
- time from trigger confirmation to anticipatory action financing release, measured against the pre-agreed lead time in the relevant playbook
- capitalisation of the solidarity reserve as a proportion of the target level defined by the Governing Board
- proportion of contributions received through multi-year commitment frameworks versus single-year contributions
- proportion of approved anticipatory action playbooks with confirmed financing sources, approved ceilings and release procedures
- proportion of emergency and anticipatory financing releases subject to financial review within the required timeframe.

20. Implementation roadmap

The implementation roadmap below follows the same managed-ambition sequence as the Continental Humanitarian Coordination and Partnership Framework. AfHA first secures the legal and governance basis for its financing systems, then builds partner relationships and capitalises initial windows, then matures its anticipatory financing and solidarity reserve as capacity and African contributions grow. Each phase is time-bounded and linked to clear outputs, not merely to elapsed time.

Within 3 months of adoption

Priority actions in this window are as follows:

- approve financing windows
- establish a resource mobilisation task team
- define financial approval thresholds
- prepare partner facing financing note
- prepare contribution registration and reporting templates.

Within 6 months

Priority actions in this window are as follows:

- map likely funding sources by category
- launch initial structured outreach to key partners
- establish emergency and anticipatory budget coding
- prepare in-kind contribution procedures
- align financing design with roadmap phases and Regional Centre plans.

Within 12 months

Priority actions in this window are as follows:

- secure initial contributions for core windows
- establish contingency and emergency release procedures
- prepare first annual financing report
- review performance of early financing mechanisms
- refine mobilisation strategy for Phase 2.

Within 24 months of adoption, AfHA should additionally: secure initial capitalisation of the solidarity reserve; confirm financing readiness for the first approved anticipatory action blueprint developed under Framework 5; establish at least one multi-year partner commitment framework; and conduct a first external review of the financing architecture.

21. Relationship with SOPs to be developed

This framework should be operationalised through a set of linked standard operating procedures. Each SOP translates the procedural provisions of the framework into step-by-step operational guidance for AfHA staff, partners and Member States. The following SOPs are required.

The financing SOPs should be aligned with the companion frameworks: emergency fund activation with Framework 1, evidence and reporting with Framework 3, surge and standby financing with Framework 4, anticipatory action financing with Framework 5, and donor engagement and visibility with Framework 6.

- SOP for drawdown mechanism
- SOP for member state and partnership contributions
- SOP for funding approval and accountability.

22. Conclusion

The Humanitarian Financing and Resource Mobilisation Framework provides the financial architecture that AfHA will need if it is to become a credible and effective continental humanitarian institution. It recognises that operational legitimacy depends not only on having money, but on having the right kinds of money, governed in the right ways, and aligned with the right priorities. If implemented well, this framework will help AfHA build a financing model that is more predictable, more transparent, more African-led and more capable of supporting timely preparedness, anticipatory action and response across the continent. It should therefore be read as the financing counterpart to the coordination, information, surge, preparedness and advocacy frameworks, rather than as a substitute for their operational provisions.

The framework makes four commitments that are more explicit than most continental humanitarian financing discussions have previously been willing to make. First, that African assessed contributions, not external goodwill, are the long-term structural foundation of AfHA's financing, and that every design choice should incrementally reinforce this, not indefinitely defer it. Second, that anticipatory action financing requires a distinct procedural architecture, not merely an additional budget line, and that this architecture, centred on pre-agreed triggers, pre-authorised actions and pre-positioned resources, must be put in place in advance of the crises it is designed to pre-empt.

Third, that multi-year commitment frameworks and partner framework agreements are operational necessities, not administrative luxuries, because fast-moving crises cannot wait for slow-moving contracting. Fourth, that a capitalised solidarity reserve, distinct from the emergency contingency stream, is the institutional expression of continental humanitarian solidarity and is the backstop that gives all other financing provisions their credibility.

Implementation will be phased and evidence-led. The bias toward managed ambition and incremental demonstration of value that runs through the Continental Humanitarian Coordination and Partnership Framework applies with equal force here. AfHA should secure its core financing first, demonstrate sound stewardship, build its anticipatory action and solidarity reserve capacity, and expand its financing architecture as African contributions, partner confidence and institutional capacity grow together. The ambition expressed in this framework is continental in scale; the implementation must be disciplined in pace, African in ownership and transparent in execution if that ambition is to become reality.